

Zen and Lemon source their products from factories in China and Taiwan, and merely re-brand them to sell them here.

The communications ministry is reportedly working with the Department of Information Technology to boost local manufacturing units. The government is concerned over revenue loss due to rise in import and also possible security threat from devices brought in from China.

Mobile number portability postponed yet again

The government has once again delayed the implementation of mobile number portability (MNP), which will now be launched by the end of October this year. With the telecom operators not ready with the infrastructure to provide the service, this will be the fourth time that the much touted mobile number portability will miss its deadline.

The mobile number portability shall allow subscribers to retain their existing telephone number when they switch from one access service provider to another, irrespective of mobile technology, or from one technology to another of the same, or any other access service provider within the same service area.

Government to pump-in Rs 200 billion more on e-governance

The Indian government plans to infuse another Rs 200 billion in various projects under the National e-Governance Plan (NeGP) in the next few years. Of all the 27 mission-mode projects envisaged under NeGP, 14 major e-governance projects including pensions, central excise, passport and common services centre have already gone live in different parts of the country.

"Almost Rs 100 billion has already been done, and another Rs 200 billion will be incurred during the remaining project life. Since this includes the operational expenditure, it will spill

even beyond 2014," says IT secretary R. Chandrashekhar.

Gujarat to use Linux in schools

The Gujarat government has decided to do away with Microsoft Windows and go for Linux in 3650 schools of the state. The state government is expected to save close to Rs 1 billion by installing Linux in schools.

"If the experiment in schools is successful, we will go ahead and do it for computers in Sachivalaya, too," said a top IT aide to chief minister Narendra



Modi. "Installation of Microsoft Windows software on each computer costs Rs 5000. With Linux, we will save huge sums," he added.

Government unveils Rs-1500 computer for students

The ministry of human resource development (HRD) has unveiled a low-cost computing device for students to browse the Internet, view videos, write and store text. Priced at \$35 (Rs 1500), the access-cum-computing device will hit the market by 2011.

By next year, universities and colleges would be encouraged to purchase the product for their students, HRD minister Kapil Sibal said. Manufacturers would now be invited to produce the device, made by a team from the IITs and the Indian Institute of Science in Bengaluru, at rates cheaper than the prototype, he added.

Dell to launch smartphones in India

Dell plans to bring its range of smartphones to the Indian market, eyeing a big slice of the hottest mobile handset market in the world. The company has sought distributors with retail reach for the same.

Maresh Bhalha, general manager (consumer), Dell India, shared, "India is one of the key markets for Dell consumers and as we work on the plans to bring the smartphones to this market, we continue to explore various go-to-market options."

Dell, the world's third largest PC maker, will be following its global counterpart Apple in introducing its handsets in India, which is dominated by low-cost handsets. The company had announced its entry into the growing smartphone category globally late last year.

Acer to introduce 3G smartphones

Acer plans to launch four to six new models of 3G-enabled Android phones in India by the end of this year. The Taiwan-headquartered firm expects to witness an enormous spurt in sales of its smartphones once 3G services are rolled out in the country.

Said S. Rajendran, chief marketing officer, Acer India, "There is a huge growth in the Indian market in terms of consumption of netbooks, notebooks and smartphones. We are looking at a 40 per cent growth this year, which will be driven mainly by our new launches in the netbook segment."

MIC forays into LED lighting

MIC Electronics, a company engaged in design, development and manufacturing of LED video displays and high-end electronic and telecommunication equipment, has decided to diversify its business model by making a full-fledged foray into LED-based lighting products and solutions.

MIC plans to launch five new LED